

(45) **Date of Patent:** Sep. 9, 2025

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Related U.S. Application Data

(63) Continuation of application No. 17/220,663, filed on Apr. 1, 2021, now Pat. No. 11,932,366.

(60) Provisional application No. 63/003,639, filed on Apr. 1, 2020.

(51) **Int. Cl.**
B63H 20/06 (2006.01)
B63B 3/48 (2006.01)
B63B 35/34 (2006.01)

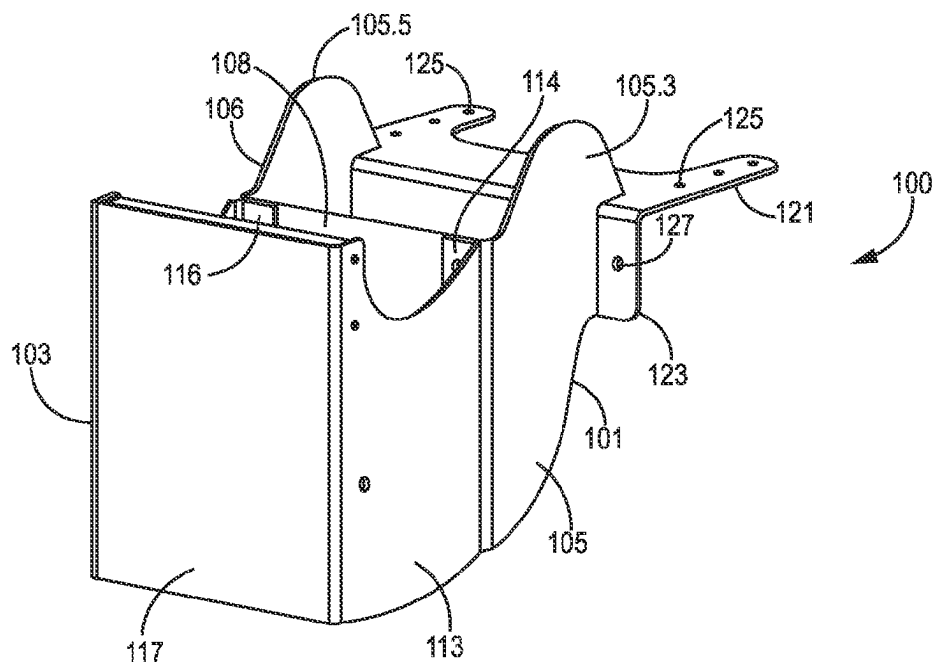
(52) **U.S. Cl.**
CPC *B63H 20/06* (2013.01); *B63B 3/48*
(2013.01); *B63B 35/34* (2013.01)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
CPC B63H 20/06; B63B 3/48; B63B 35/34
See application file for complete search history.

ABSTRACT

In embodiments, the kicker mount system comprises a deck mount unit connected to a kicker motor receiving unit, both cantilevered off of the stern end of pontoon boat deck. The deck having a horizontal deck pad and trim rail about the deck pad. The kicker mount system attaches exclusively to the deck on the deck pad and on the trim rail without any additional support structure securing the kicker mount system to the pontoon boat. The kicker motor receiving unit is vertically adjustably attached to the deck mount unit. The deck mount unit having an L-shaped pontoon deck plate with a horizontal portion that attaches to the deck top surface, and a vertical portion that attaches with a toggle bolt into the trim rail. Upright cantilevered extension plates project rearward from the L-shaped deck plate, the extension plates having a hump portion projecting upwardly above the deck plate.

16 Claims, 9 Drawing Sheets



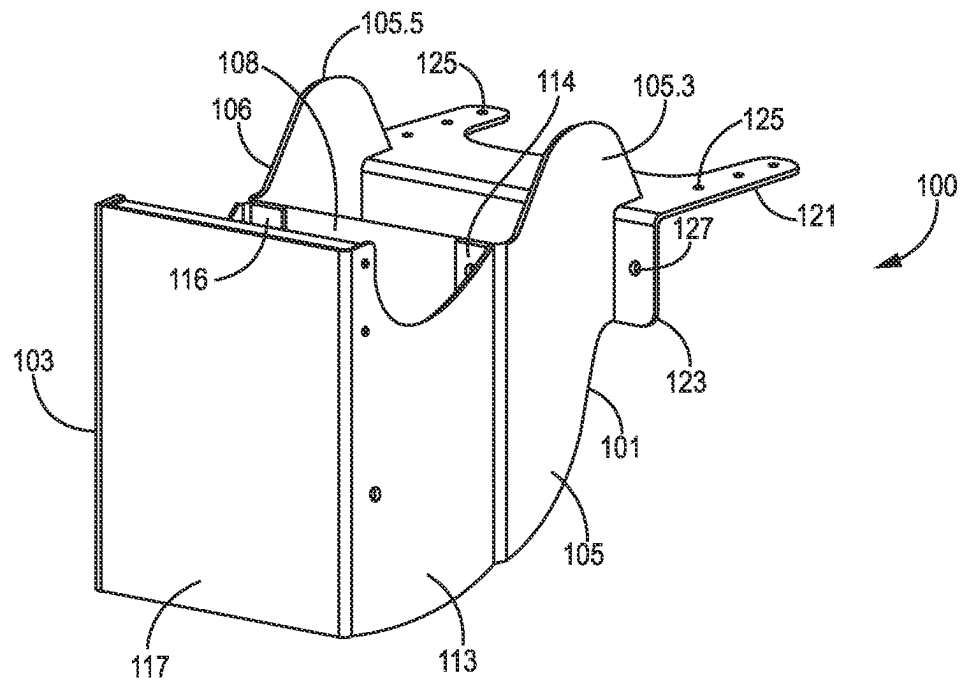


FIG. 1A

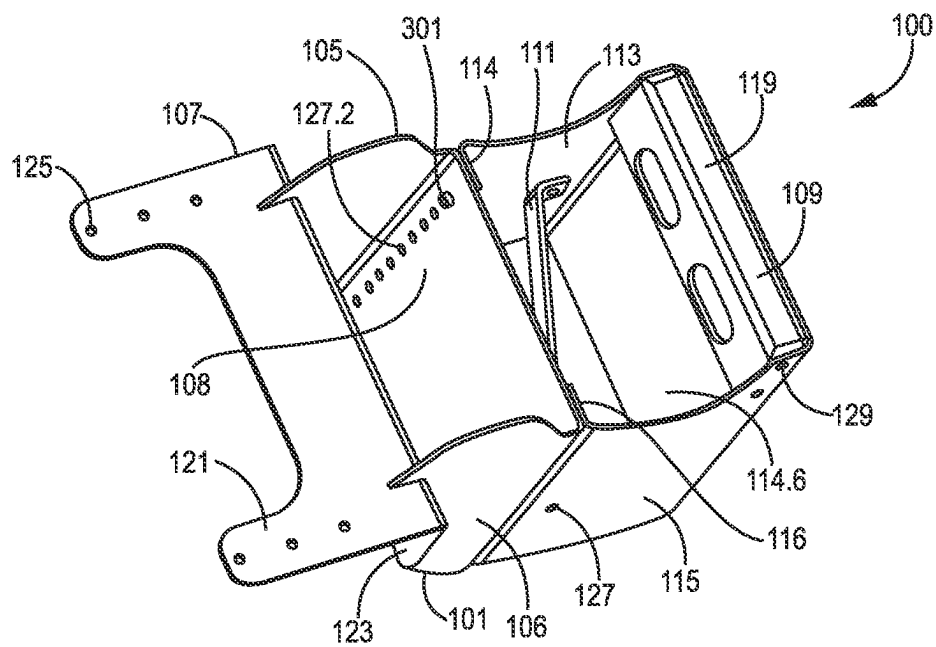
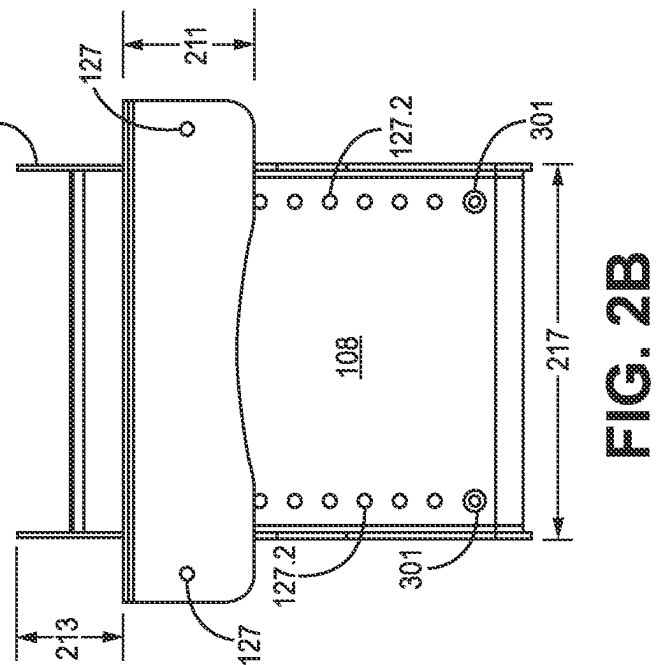
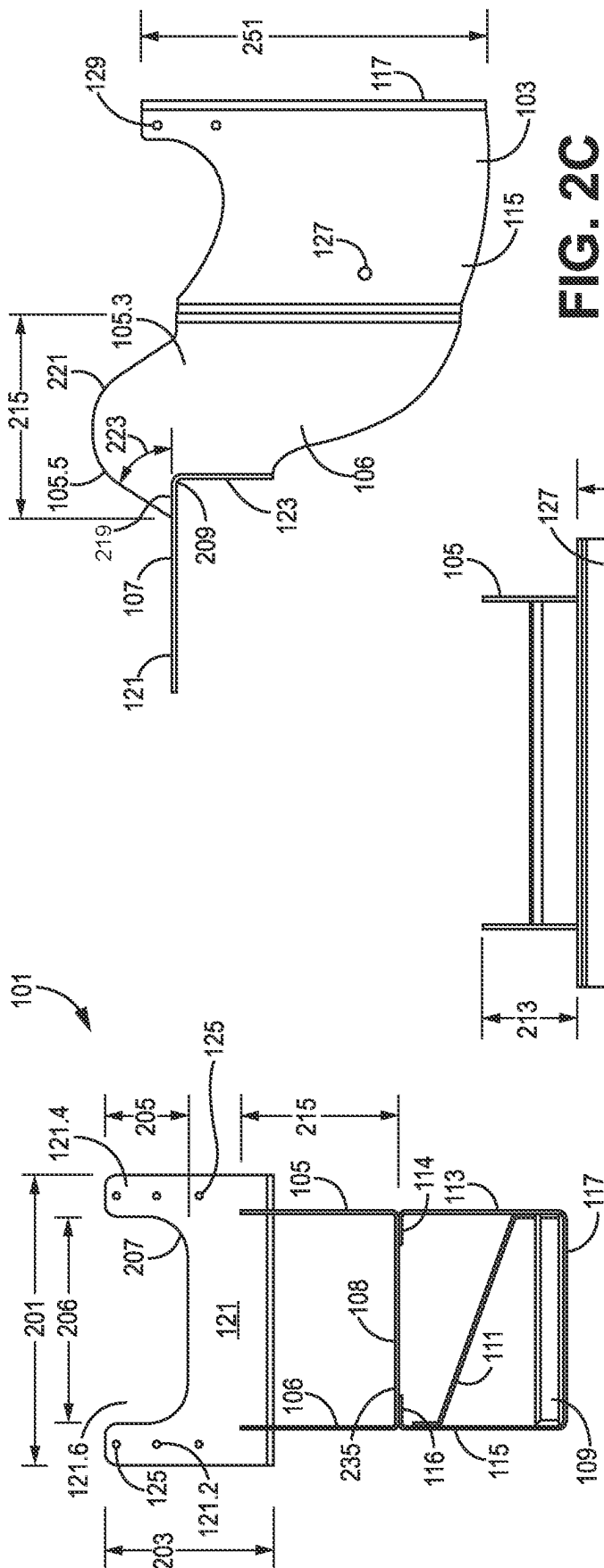


FIG. 1B



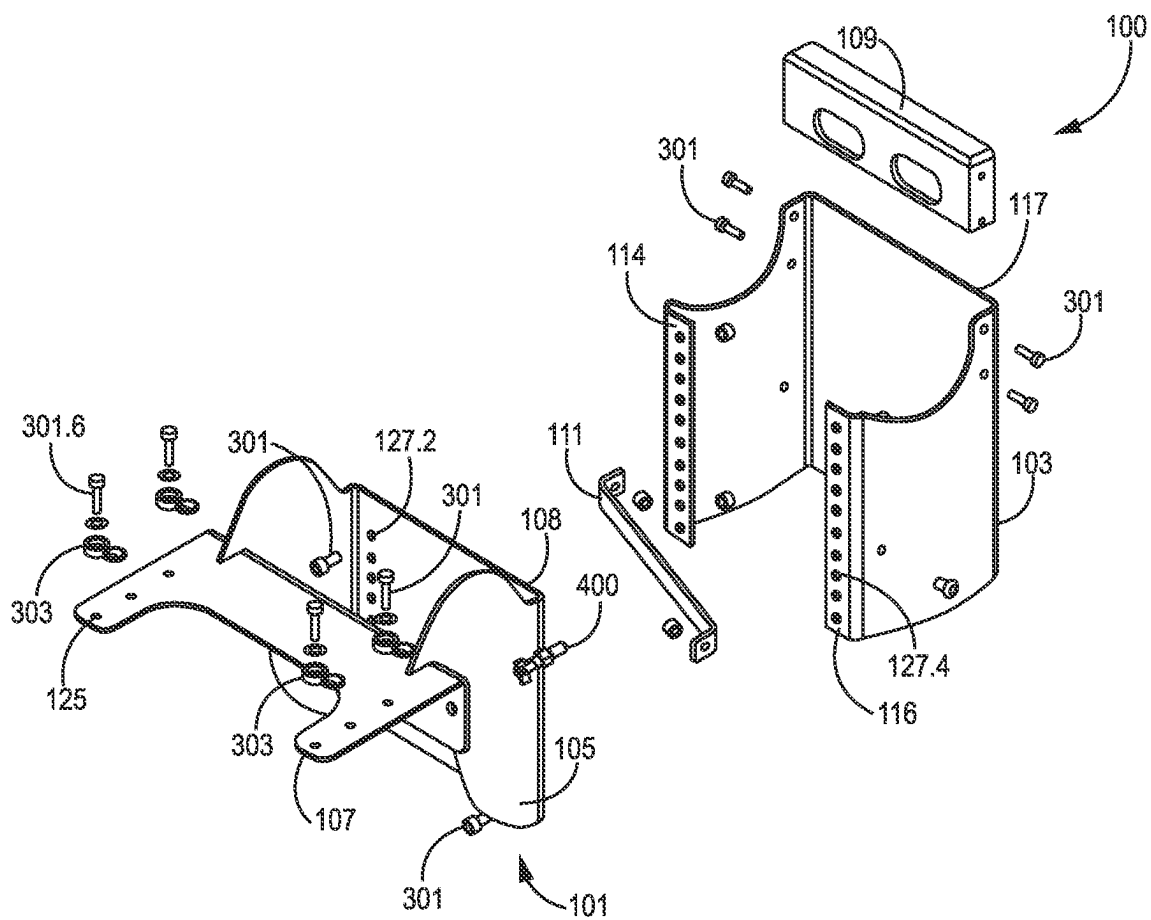


FIG. 3

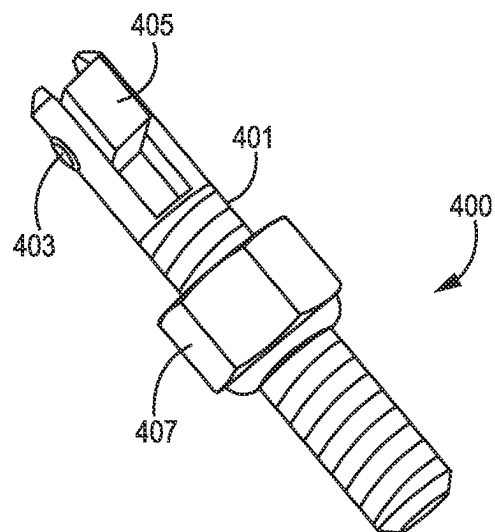


FIG. 4A

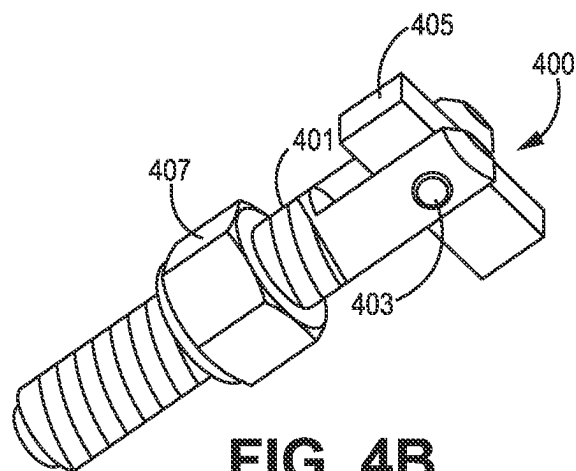


FIG. 4B

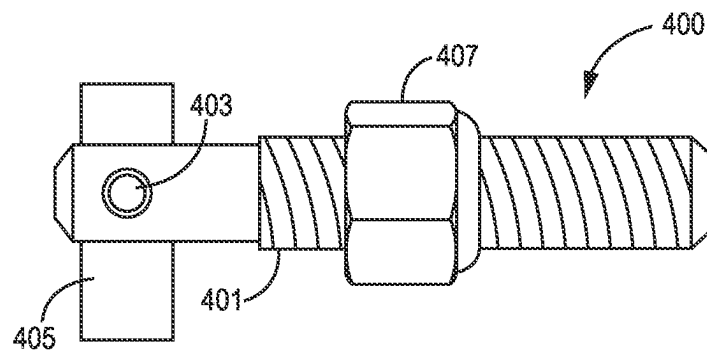


FIG. 4C

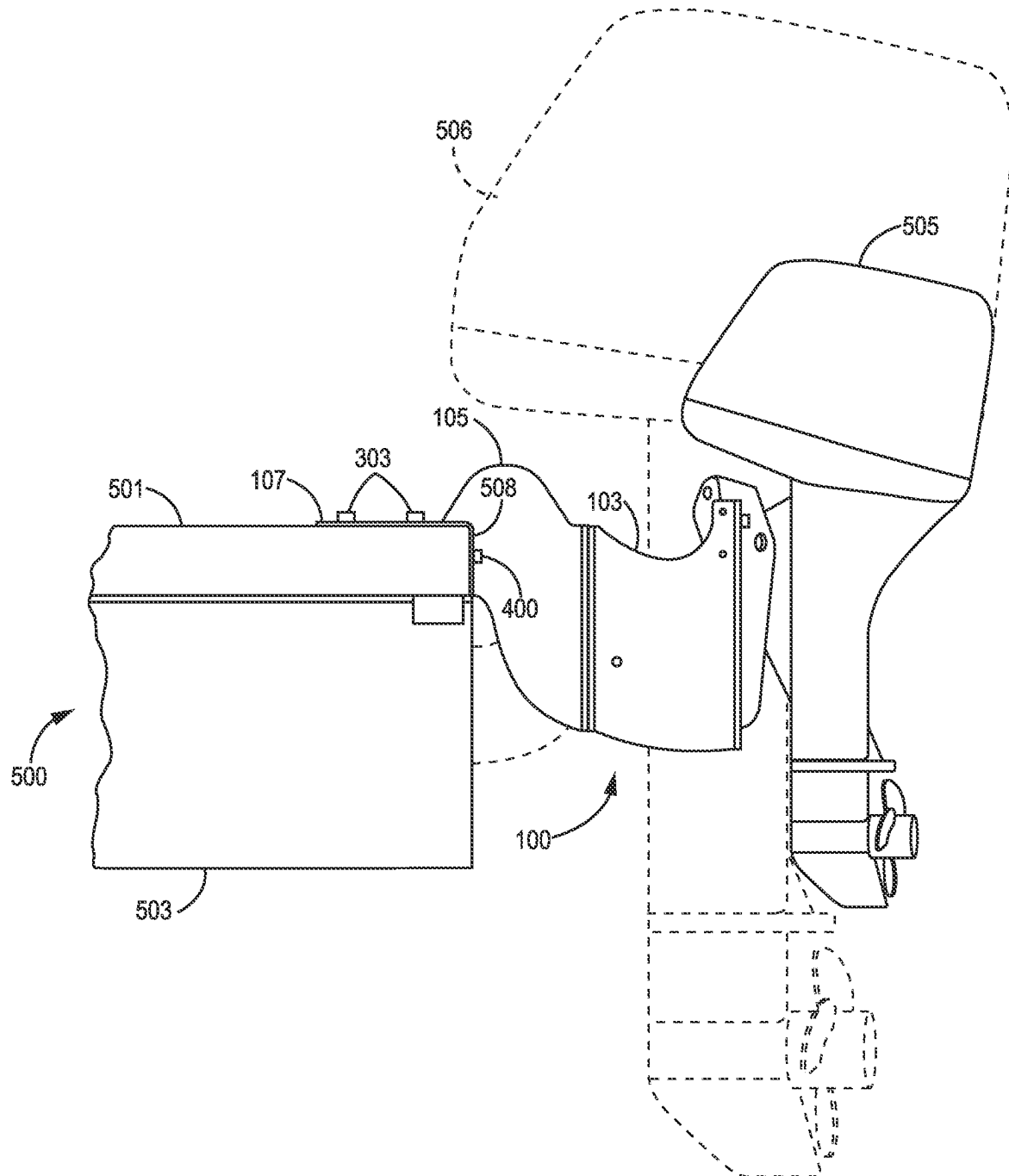
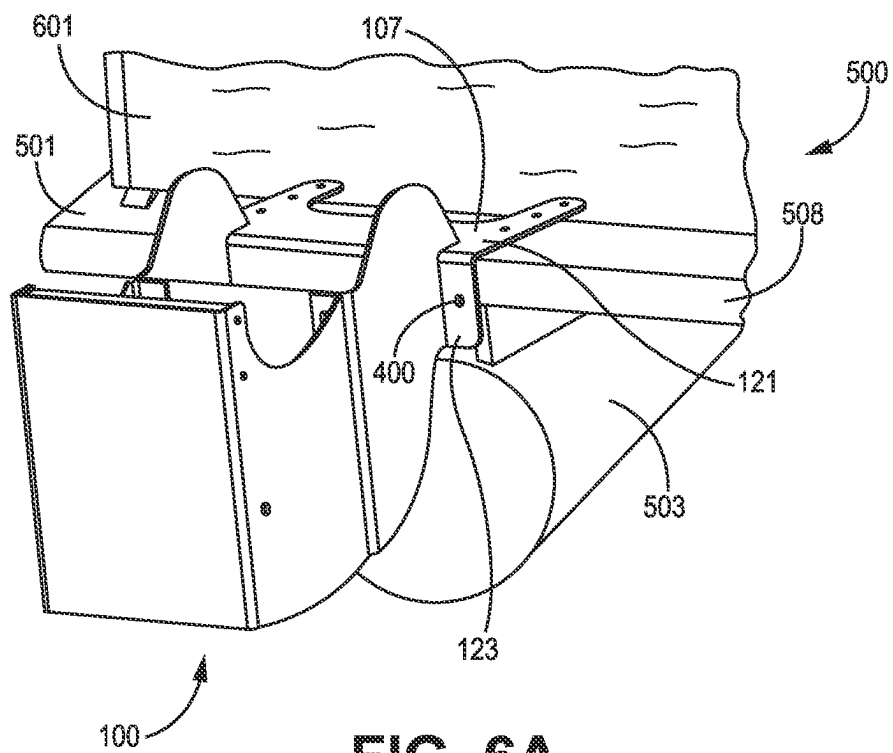


FIG. 5



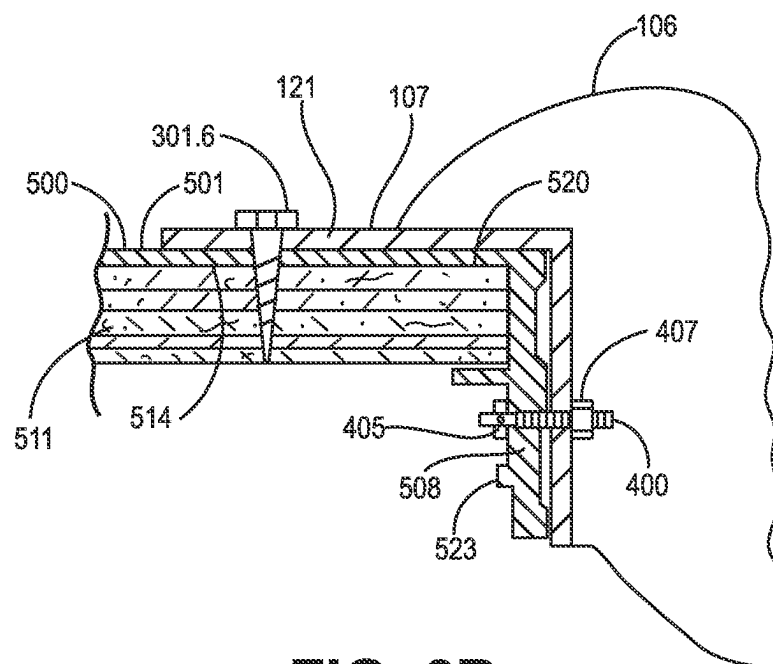


FIG. 6B

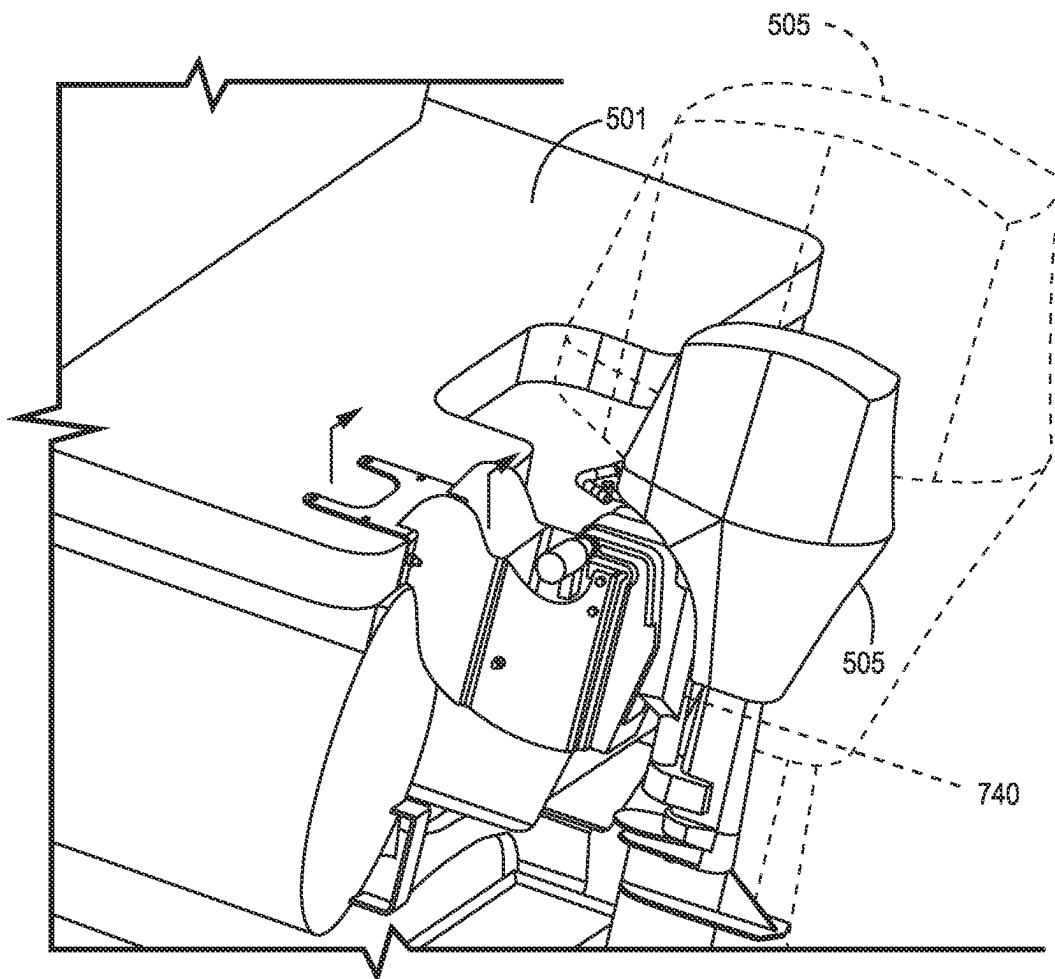


FIG. 7

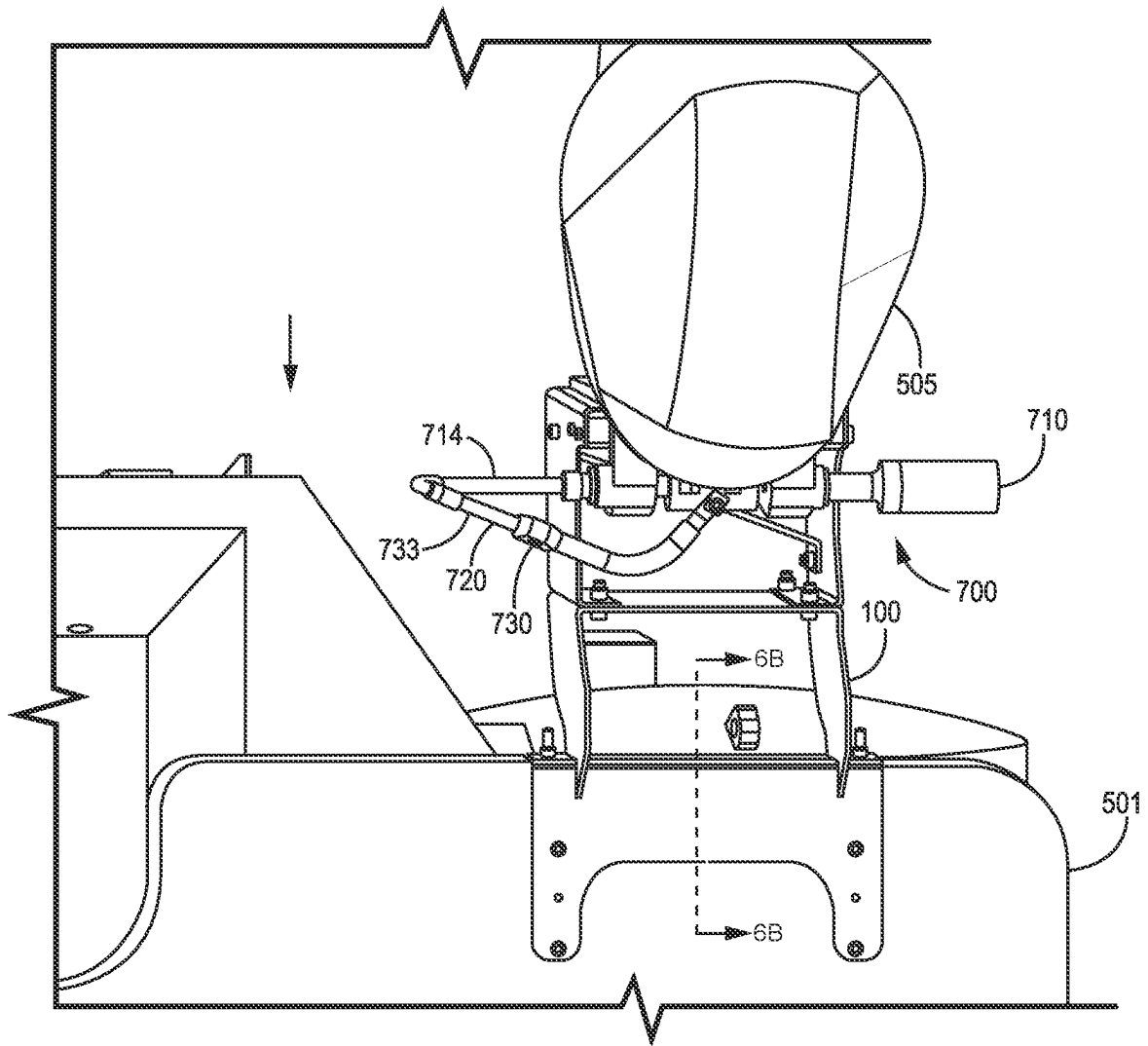


FIG. 8

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PONTOON KICKER MOTOR MOUNT**CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS**

The present application claims the benefit of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/220,663, filed Apr. 1, 2021, and U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/003,639, filed Apr. 1, 2020, each of which is hereby fully incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to accessories for boats and outboard motors. More particularly, it relates to outboard motor mounts for pontoon boats.

BACKGROUND

Kicker motors, sometimes referred to as a spare outboard motor or a trolling motor, are typically mounted to the side of a main, larger outboard motor. Kicker motors serve a number of useful functions beyond merely being a backup in the event of main engine failure. Kicker motors are generally quieter than main outboard motors. Kicker motors may be generally better suited for activities than a main outboard motor such as maintaining a position or gently propelling a boat through water, particularly when fishing. Such activities are often enjoyed on pontoon boats. Pontoon boats typically have a flat deck atop two or more pontoon hull structures. The flat deck is typically made of plywood and has outer trim attached to the edge and extending entirely around the perimeter of the deck. A prior art kicker motor mount for a pontoon boat is illustrated in U.S. Pat. No. 9,022,342 illustrating the kicker motor mounted behind a pontoon.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The shape of the transom on pontoon boats makes it difficult to easily and securely attach a secondary motor. Further, as maintaining the integrity of the pontoon hull structures is critical to keeping a pontoon boat afloat, it is generally unwise to mount anything to the hull structure, particularly using fasteners which could penetrate the structure and impact floatability. Further yet, the round, tubular structure of the two or more pontoon hull structures in close proximity to the flat deck atop the hull structures creates very small and hard to reach spaces making it difficult to securely attach items to the transom and/or decking of a pontoon boat. A mounting system that can attach a kicker motor to a pontoon boat without the need to get underneath the boat or use specialized tools, and further without compromising the integrity of the pontoon hull structures, would be well received by the industry. The device of the present application substantially meets the aforementioned needs of the industry. The kicker motor mounting system provides a mechanism easily secured to a pontoon boat using standard tools and minimizing or eliminating the need to go under the boat or access tight spaces.

The flat deck in conventional pontoon boats is typically made of plywood deck pad and has an outer trim configured as a rail attached to an edge of the plywood deck pad and extending entirely around the perimeter of the plywood deck pad. The outer trim rail, also known as a rub rail, generally being formed of extruded aluminum and having a shape in cross section of an inverted L. The short leg mounting on the

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top of the plywood deck and the longer leg engaging the edge of the plywood deck and extending several inches below the lower surface of the deck. The downwardly extending leg typically having reinforcing structure projecting inwardly and along the length of the trim rail. A fence about 26 inches high extends around the deck perimeter and may be offset rearwardly from the bow edge of the deck and forwardly from the stern edge of the deck.

In embodiments, a kicker motor mount for a pontoon boat has a motor receiving unit that is vertically adjustably attached to a deck mount unit. When viewed from above, the motor receiving unit having opposing parallel wall portions defining a box shape with an open top and open bottom. When viewed from above, the deck mount unit having opposing parallel walls defining a box shape with open top and bottom. The deck mount unit having an L-shaped pontoon deck plate with a horizontal deck plate portion extends over the short leg of the trim rail and that attaches to the deck top surface, and a vertical deck plate portion connected at a right angle to the horizontal deck plate portion and that extends down along the trim rail and attaches with a toggle bolt into the trim rail. A pair of upright cantilevered extension plates project rearward from the L-shaped deck plate, each upright extension plate having an L-shaped interface with the deck plate and being welded to the horizontal deck plate portion and also being welded to the vertical deck plate portion. In embodiments, each extension plate having an upper margin that extends upwardly from the horizontal deck plate portion and rearwardly defining a first arcuate curve, and a lower margin that extends rearwardly and downwardly from a lower edge of the vertical deck plate portion defining a second arcuate curve. The upright extension plates extending rearwardly to a rearward attachment portion comprising a bridging plate portion or a pair of flanges. The attachment portion having a height greater than a height of the vertical deck plate portion. A pair of columns of vertically aligned apertures are respectively positioned at a starboard side of the rearward attachment portion and a port side of the rearward attachment portion. A connecting plate portion of the motor receiving unit abuts against the attachment portion of the deck mount unit and has a plurality of holes in selective alignment with the apertures of the pair of columns of vertically aligned apertures providing the vertical adjustability. Fasteners such as bolts and nuts adjoin the connecting portion of the motor receiving unit to the rearward attachment portion of the deck mount unit. The connecting portion can be a bridging plate or a pair of flange portions. A pair of sidewalls extend rearward from the connecting portion of the motor receiving unit to a rearward kicker motor mounting end plate. A clamping block may be positioned within the motor receiving unit at the kicker motor mounting end plate.

A feature and advantage of embodiments is that the kicker mount is securely attached to pontoon boat only at the pontoon deck. The kicker motor mount is secured to the trim rail and to the deck pad and does not rely upon brackets or other attachment structure associated with the pontoon hulls or struts supporting the pontoon hulls.

A feature and advantage of embodiments is the kicker mount is attached using threaded fasteners that do not need cooperating nuts on the threaded ends of the fasteners. In embodiments a minimal number of fasteners are needed to securely attach the kicker motor mount.

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A feature and advantage of embodiments is the kicker mount places the kicker motor rearwardly of one of the pontoon hulls of the pontoon boat and is vertically adjustable.

In embodiments, the kicker mount system comprises two cooperating unitary steel box structures cantilevered off of the stern end of pontoon boat deck. From a side view, the two box structures present an S-shape rotated forward ninety degrees. The vertical height of the box shape structures converging toward the stern end of the pontoon boat deck.

In embodiments, cantilevered extension plates have an upwardly extending hump portion extending above an L-shaped welded interface with an L-shaped deck plate, the hump portion and the L-shaped interface effectively strengthening the connection between the extension with the L-shaped deck plate as well as strengthening the L-shaped plate, such that it effectively cannot bend out of the L-shape, and greatly reducing the tension that would be on the vertical weldment between the cantilevered extension plate and the deck plate. The upwardly extending hump portions facilitate a vertical interface with the deck of only the deck thickness defined by the height of the trim rail. A feature and advantage is that the enhanced strength provided by the humped portion between the L-shaped deck plate and the cantilevered extension plates allows the connection of the motor mount to the pontoon boat to be exclusively at the stern end of the deck with a pair of fasteners extending through a vertical portion of the deck plate into the trim rail and only two or four threaded fasteners extending through the horizontal portion of the deck plate into the deck pad.

The above summary is not intended to describe each illustrated embodiment or every implementation of the present disclosure.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

FIG. 1A is a perspective rear view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 1B is a perspective front view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 2A is a top view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 2B is a front view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 2C is a side view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system including exemplary fasteners according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 4A is a perspective view of a toggle bolt fastener for a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 4B is a perspective view of a toggle bolt fastener for a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 4C is a side view of a toggle bolt fastener for a pontoon boat kicker mounting system according to an embodiment of the disclosure.

FIG. 5 is a side view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system with a deck mounting plate secured to a pontoon boat and a kicker motor secured to the pontoon boat kicker mounting system.

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FIG. 6A is a perspective view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system mounted to a pontoon boat with a portion of the deck plate slid under a fence on the deck of the pontoon boat.

FIG. 6B is a cross section of the interface between the pontoon boat kicker mounting system and the deck of a pontoon boat.

FIG. 7 is a perspective side view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system with a deck mounting plate secured to a pontoon boat and a kicker motor secured to the pontoon boat kicker mounting system.

FIG. 8 is a perspective top view of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system with a deck mounting plate secured to a pontoon boat and a kicker motor secured to the pontoon boat kicker mounting system.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

Referring to FIGS. 1A-1B, a pontoon boat kicker mounting system **100** is illustrated having a deck mount unit **101** and motor receiving unit **103**. Deck mount unit **101** includes upright starboard extension plate **105**, port extension plate **106**, deck plate **107**, and an attachment portion **108** configured as a bridging plate functioning as a backwall of the deck mount unit. In other embodiments, the attachment portion could be a pair of aperture flanges. In embodiments, the deck mount is a unitary unit with deck plate **107**, the extension plates **105**, **106**, and the attachment portion **108** all formed of metal and being integral and/or unitary such as by welding or bending of steel plates.

In embodiments, motor receiving unit **103** has a kicker motor mounting end plate **117** that is unitary with starboard sidewall **113** and port sidewall **115**, which connect to and are unitary with connection portion which is illustrated as configured as a pair of apertured flanges **114**, **116**. Motor receiving unit may be an integral or unitary component with the end plate, sidewall, and connecting portion all welded or formed of bent metal, such as steel or aluminum, plate. Brace **111** may be added within an interior cavity **114.6** spanning between starboard sidewall **113** and port sidewall **115** for rigidifying the box structure.

In embodiments, clamping block **109** also fits within motor receiving unit **103**. Clamping block **109** is rectangular block and is positioned such that a back surface is generally flush with back wall **117**, side surfaces are generally flush with starboard and port sidewalls **113**, **115** and top surface **119** is generally flush with a top edge of motor receiving unit **103**.

As best seen in FIG. 1A, when viewed from above, the kicker mount system deck mount unit **101** is configured as a box with an open top and open bottom.

Referring to FIGS. 2A-2C, deck plate **107** has an L-shaped profile with horizontal deck plate portion or long leg **121** and vertical deck plate portion or short leg **123**. As shown in FIG. 2A, long leg **121**, when viewed from above, is generally U-shaped with mounting apertures **125** along the forward extending side finger portions **121.2**, **121.4**. In embodiments, the forward extending side finger portions of the long leg **121** define a recess **121.6**. When mounted, long leg **121** extends along the deck of a pontoon boat and may protrude into areas accessed by users, for example under a pontoon fence. Minimizing material in these areas is advantageous to avoid tripping or other injury. Each side portion of long leg **121** may have one or more mounting apertures **125**. While using only two or four apertures may be sufficient for securing long leg **121** to the deck of a pontoon boat, there may be obstacles impeding access to mounting aper-

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tures **125** on some boats. Offering a plurality of mounting apertures **125** ensures there will be enough exposed mounting apertures **125** to securely fasten long leg **121** to the deck of a pontoon boat.

In embodiments, long leg **121** has a width **201** between 10 and 24 inches. In embodiments, width **201** is about 14 inches. In embodiments, long leg **121** has a length **203** between 4 and 16 inches. In embodiments, length **203** is about 8 inches. In embodiments, the cut away portion of long leg **121** has a length **205** of about four inches and a width **206** of about ten inches. In embodiments, the cut away portion of long leg **121** has a radius **207** of about 2 inches. It is preferable that where users come into contact with components of the pontoon boat kicker mounting system, that those components are scrubbed of burrs and sharp edges are removed such as by rounding corners or beveling edges. In embodiments, mounting apertures **125** have a diameter of about 0.31 inches. In embodiments, mounting apertures **125** are about twelve inches from center to center. In embodiments, mounting apertures **125** are about one inch from the nearest side edge of long leg **121**. In embodiments, mounting apertures **125** are less than one inch from a forward edge of long leg **121**. In embodiments, long leg **121** has six mounting apertures **125**. In embodiments, long leg **121** has four to ten mounting apertures **125**.

Referring to FIGS. 1A to 2C, in embodiments, short leg **123** of deck plate **107** has a height **211** between two and six inches. In embodiments, short leg **123** has a height of about 3.688 inches. Short leg **123** and long leg **121** meet at radius **209**. Deck plate **107** is generally configured such that when long leg **121** is mounted on the deck of a pontoon boat, short leg **123** abuts the trim rail of the pontoon boat. In embodiments, radius **209** is about 0.178 inches. In embodiments, short leg **123** has a plurality of bolt holes **127**. In embodiments, short leg **123** has two bolt holes **127**. In embodiments, bolt holes **127** may be about 12.5 inches from center to center. In embodiments, bolt holes **127** have a larger diameter than mounting apertures **125**. In embodiments, bolt holes **127** have a diameter of about 0.41 inches.

As depicted in the top view in FIG. 2A, the pontoon deck mount unit port and starboard extension plates **105**, **106** have a length **215** between five and eight inches. In embodiments, port and starboard extension plates **105**, **106** have a length **215** of 7.5 inches. In embodiments, attachment portion configured as a back wall **108** has a width **217** between five and fifteen inches. In embodiments, width **217** is about 10.5 inches. The attachment portion, back wall **108** has a plurality of holes **127.2** for threaded fasteners **301** to connect the deck mount unit **101** and the motor mount unit.

An upper portion of extension plates **105**, **106** are unitary with deck plate **107**. Extension plates **105** have a hump portion **105.3** that extends upwardly above deck plate **107** with a height **213** between two and six inches. In embodiments, height **213** is about three inches. In embodiments, a top margin **105.5** of extension plates has a curved profile with a radius **221** between 1.5 and 2.5 inches on either side of the peak. In embodiments, radius **221** is about two inches. In embodiments, extension plate **105** forms an angle **223** with long leg **121** between forty and eighty degrees. In embodiments, angle **223** is about sixty degrees. Upper hump portion **105.3** of extension plate **105** extends over long leg **121** of deck plate **107**. In embodiments, the overlap length **219** is between one and three inches. In embodiments, the bolt holes **125**, **127** of the deck plate are positioned laterally exterior with respect to the starboard and port extension plates **105**, **106**. Accordingly, bolt holes **127** remain easily accessible to a user for securing deck plate **107** to a pontoon

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boat. Deck plate **107** is fixedly attached to extension plates **105**. A fixed attachment includes any attachment means that is permanent in nature such that separating the components would cause damage to one or more of the components. For example, in embodiments, deck plate **107** is welded to extension plate **105**. Having a portion of extension plate **105** extend vertically above deck plate **107** redirects forces exerted on deck plate **107** when a kicker motor is mounted. Accordingly, this redirection of forces permits deck plate **107** to be secured to a pontoon boat with fewer fasteners and without extensive bracing along the sides of a pontoon hull or the underside of the boat. The arcuate profile may be varied for aesthetic or other purposes. For example, the profile may be altered to be more rectangular than arcuate without impacting the ability to reduce fasteners and eliminate additional bracing. Similarly, dimensions disclosed may be varied to accommodate larger or smaller kicker motors.

Motor receiving unit **103** is generally configured as a box, with port sidewall **113**, starboard sidewall **115**, end plate **117**, and connection portion. Connection portion is configured as a pair of mounting flanges **114**, **116**, adjoining port sidewall **113**, and starboard wall **115** respectively. Each mounting flange **114**, **116** includes a plurality of bolt holes **127.4** corresponding to bolt holes **127.2** in rear wall **108** of the deck mount unit **101**. In embodiments, mounting flanges **114**, **116** have a height equivalent to the height of rear wall **108** connection to extension plates **105**, **106**. In embodiments, back wall **117** of motor receiving unit **103** has a height **251** between eight and sixteen inches. In embodiments, back wall **117** is taller than mounting flanges **114**, **116**. In embodiments, height **251** is about 12.75 inches. In embodiments, a top edge of starboard and port walls **113**, **115** has an arcuate profile. The profile may have a larger radius towards mounting flanges **114**, **116** and a smaller radius towards rear wall **117**. A top portion of motor receiving unit may be configured to retain clamping block **109**. Clamping block may be positioned such that it is simultaneously flush with rear wall **117** and the top portions of port and starboard walls, **113**, **115**. Clamping block may be formed of a block of polymer, wood, composite, or other materials. The top portion of motor receiving unit **103** further includes a plurality of thru holes **129** aligned with clamping block **109**. In embodiments, thru holes **129** have a diameter of about 0.28 inches. In embodiments, each of starboard and port walls **113**, **115** have two thru holes **129**. Fasteners inserted through thru holes **129** may retain clamping block **109** in place. It will be appreciated by those in the art that the raised top portion of motor receiving unit **103** along with the arcuate top edge of port and starboard walls **113**, **115** provide a user easier access to clamping block **109**. Easy access to clamping block **109** facilitates securing a kicker motor to the pontoon boat kicker mounting system as will be discussed below. To minimize shearing forces, one or more cross bars **111** may be mounted between starboard and port walls **113**, **115**. Bolt holes **127** in starboard and port walls **113**, **115** provide mounting locations for cross bars **111**. In embodiments, a single cross bar **111** may be mounted diagonally. For example, a first end of cross bar **111** might be mounted on starboard wall **115** near mounting flange **116** and the opposite end of cross bar **111** might be mounted on port wall **113** near to rear wall **117**. In embodiments, two or more cross bars **111** may be mounted in a variety of patterns. For example, two cross bars **111** might be mounted in parallel with one another and parallel to rear wall **117**.

Referring to FIG. 3, an exemplary pontoon boat kicker mounting system **100** is shown in an exploded view along

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with exemplary fasteners **301**. Fasteners **301** may releasably couple components to one another or to a pontoon boat. For example, fasteners **301** may include screws, socket head screws, flat head screws, bolts, lag bolts, or other similar devices as known to one skilled in the art. In some instances where a user may come into contact with a fastener **301**, such as fasteners **301** used on the decking of a pontoon boat, a portion of fastener **301** that might otherwise be exposed can be hidden. For example, using a hinged fastener cap **303** could prevent a user from injuring their foot or toes on the head of an exposed fastener **301**.

Bolt holes **127** in rear wall **235** of extension plate **105** generally correspond to bolt holes **127** in mounting flanges **114**, **116** of motor receiving unit **103**. As seen in the side view shown in FIG. **2C**, a pontoon boat kicker mount system **100** may be assembled such that top and bottom edges of rear wall **235** and mounting flanges **114**, **116** are generally flush. However, it may be desirable to vertically offset extension plate **105** and motor receiving unit **103**. As extension plate **105** is fixed relative to the pontoon boat, raising or lowering motor receiving unit **103** will in turn raise or lower a mounted kicker motor relative to a pontoon boat and the water. For example, a larger kicker motor may require raising motor receiving unit **103** whereas a smaller kicker motor may require lowering motor receiving unit **103** to ensure the propellers of a kicker motor are at the desired depth in a body of water.

FIGS. **4A-4B** illustrate a toggle bolt **401** that can secure deck plate **107** to a trim rail of a deck of a pontoon boat without the need for additional bracing, getting underneath the boat, or accessing tight spaces with tools. Toggle bolt **400** has a bolt body **401** having a threaded shaft and notched on an opposite end. The notched portion has through apertures to receive pin **403**. Swivel anchor **405** is sized to fit within the notched portion of bolt body **401**. Swivel anchor is rotatably mounted to bolt body **401** with pin **403** acting as a pivot point such that a portion of swivel anchor **405** is captured within the notched portion. In embodiments, swivel anchor **405** is mounted off-center such that one end of swivel anchor **405** is stopped by bolt body **401** before passing through the notched portion, thereby limiting swivel anchor **405** to a rotation of less than 360 degrees. Swivel anchor **405** can be oriented such that it is able to pass through bolt hole **127** and a corresponding hole in the trim rail of the deck of a pontoon boat. Swivel anchor **405** can then flip open and be secured in place by threading nut **407** onto bolt body **401**. Accordingly, deck plate **107** will be sandwiched between swivel anchor **405** and nut **407** and firmly held in place.

Referring to FIGS. **5** and **6A**, a side view and rear perspective views of a pontoon boat kicker mounting system **100** is shown with deck plate **107** mounted to a deck **501** of a pontoon boat **500** without utilizing, engaging or contacting pontoon hull structures **503**. Outboard kicker motor **505** is secured to the kicker mount system **100**. The main pontoon motor **506** is illustrated by dashed lines is attached to the pontoon transom, not shown in this view. Hinged fastener caps **303** help protect users on deck **501** from being injured by fasteners. Toggle bolt **400** secures deck plate **107** to the deck by way of the trim rail **503** of the deck **501**. FIG. **6** illustrates a portion of long leg **121** passes underneath a fence **601** secured to the deck **501** of the pontoon boat.

Referring to FIG. **6B**, a cross section of the connection between the pontoon boat **500** and the kicker mount system. The pontoon boat deck **501** comprises a deck pad **511** which is typically plywood, and the trim rail **508** that extends around the periphery of the deck. The trim rail is typically an aluminum strip having an L-shape as illustrated and

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extends over the top surface **520** of the plywood deck pad securely attached to the deck pad. The deck pad is typically covered such as by carpet or other covering **514**. The deck plate is secured to the deck by the screw **301.6** extending through a hole in the horizontal deck plate portion **121** into the plywood deck pad, and by the toggle bolt body **401** and nut **407**. The swivel anchor **405** is engaged with the inside surface **523** of the trim rail **508**.

Deck plate **107**, extension plate **105**, motor receiving unit **103**, and brace **111** may be made of any durable materials. For example, deck plate **107**, extension plate **105**, motor receiving unit **103**, and brace **111** may be made of metal or sheet metal. In embodiments, deck plate **107**, extension plate **105**, motor receiving unit **103**, and brace **111** may be made from 10 gauge steel. While steel or other metals are highly durable, they are susceptible to rust and wear from being used in the water. Accordingly, in embodiments, the metal is coated. For example, the metal be powder coated. In embodiments, metal components may be ceramic coated.

FIGS. **7** and **8** are perspective views of the kicker mount system **100** secured to the deck **501** of a pontoon boat **500** and the kicker motor **505** is secured to the kicker mount system **100**. A remote steering unit **700** comprises an electric motor **710**, an extendable and retractable shaft **714** pivotally connected to a tubular J-bar **720** that has an adjustable length provided by the nut **730** that tightens onto the telescoping shaft **733**. The J-bar pivotally connects to the motor which has a pivot **740** with a vertical or upright axis allowing the motor to rotate about the axis. The arcuate top edge of the port and starboard walls of the motor receiving unit provides additional clearance for remote steering unit **700**.

The following patents are incorporated by reference for all purposes: U.S. Pat. Nos. 9,022,342; 9,598,159; 8,535,105; 5,782,662; 8,657,637.

The invention is not restricted to the details of the foregoing embodiment(s). The invention extends to any novel one, or any novel combination, of the features disclosed in this specification (including any incorporated by reference references, any accompanying claims, abstract and drawings), or to any novel one, or any novel combination, of the steps of any method or process so disclosed. The above references in all sections of this application are herein incorporated by references in their entirety for all purposes.

Although specific examples have been illustrated and described herein, it will be appreciated by those of ordinary skill in the art that any arrangement calculated to achieve the same purpose could be substituted for the specific examples shown. This application is intended to cover adaptations or variations of the present subject matter. Therefore, it is intended that the invention be defined by the attached claims and their legal equivalents, as well as the following illustrative aspects. The above described aspects embodiments of the invention are merely descriptive of its principles and are not to be considered limiting. Further modifications of the invention herein disclosed will occur to those skilled in the respective arts and all such modifications are deemed to be within the scope of the invention.

The invention claimed is:

1. A kicker motor mount system for attachment to only the deck of a pontoon boat, the deck having a deck pad and a trim rail, the kicker motor mount system comprising:
 - a deck mount unit having an L-shaped deck;
 - an extension plate unitary with and extending rearwardly from the L-shaped deck plate, the extension plate having a forward hump portion extending over the L-shaped deck plate; and

a kicker motor receiving unit attached to the extension plate and adjustable vertically thereto, wherein the kicker motor receiving unit comprises a pair of flanges abutting the extension plate.

2. A kicker motor mount system for attachment to only the deck of a pontoon boat, the deck having a deck pad and a trim rail, the kicker motor mount system comprising:

a deck mount unit having an L-shaped deck plate;

a cantilevered extension plate extending rearwardly from the deck mount unit; and

a kicker motor receiving unit attached to the cantilevered extension plate and adjustable vertically thereto, wherein a top portion of the kicker motor receiving unit comprises an arcuate profile.

3. The kicker motor mount system of claim 2, wherein the cantilevered extension plate extends upwardly from the deck.

4. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the deck mount unit comprises a horizontal deck plate portion with apertures for receiving threaded fasteners.

5. The kicker motor mount system of claim 4, wherein a vertical deck plate portion extends downwardly from the horizontal deck plate portion.

6. The kicker motor mount system of claim 5, wherein the vertical deck plate portion extends downwardly from the horizontal deck portion no more than 6 inches and having a pair of apertures for receiving a pair of fasteners, the pair of aperture within 4 inches of the horizontal plate portion.

7. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the extension plate is a pair of extension plates.

8. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the extension plate is unitary with the horizontal deck plate portion.

9. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the extension plate is unitary with the vertical deck plate portion.

10. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the extension plate is welded to the deck mount unit.

11. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the flanges of the kicker motor receiving unit and the extension plate have corresponding apertures, the corresponding apertures configured to receive threaded fasteners such that a vertical offset between the kicker motor receiving unit and the extension plate may be adjusted.

12. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the kicker motor receiving unit comprises a mounting block.

13. The kicker motor mount system of claim 1, wherein the kicker motor receiving unit comprises a port sidewall and a starboard sidewall, and wherein one or more support braces extends from the port sidewall to the starboard sidewall.

14. The kicker motor mount system of claim 2, wherein, from a side view, the cantilevered extension plate and the kicker motor receiving unit present an S-shape rotated forward ninety degrees.

15. The kicker motor mount system of claim 2, wherein the L-shaped deck plate comprises a horizontal deck plate portion with apertures for receiving threaded fasteners and a vertical plate portion extending downwardly from the horizontal deck portion having a pair of apertures for receiving fastener.

16. The kicker motor mount system of claim 2, wherein the kicker motor receiving unit comprises a port sidewall and a starboard sidewall, the sidewalls further comprising flanges abutting the cantilevered extension plate.

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